AEP FROM ZERO • PART 1 • KNOW YOUR CUSTOMER (AEP)

EPISODE 10

AEP Segment Builder Tutorial: Build Audiences

An Adobe Experience Platform Segment Builder tutorial from zero: how to create an audience in AEP with Build rule, and when to use Compose audience instead. You will learn why an audience is a living rule and a list is a snapshot, the Segment Builder's three panels, and its four kinds of logic: attributes, events with a time window, sequential 'not followed by' rules and exclusion. Bloom builds five Real-Time CDP audiences from a written spec, including a cart abandonment audience and a

Previously: Priya finally appears

- Last time: lake and graph full, profile store empty
- Two days later: profile ingestion restored
- Re-ingest: New profile fragments above zero
- Priya: one profile, three identities
- Today: five audiences for the relaunch

KEY IDEA

Profile ingestion is restored, Priya is one person with three identities, and Anjali can finally ask: who do we talk to first?

Who do we talk to first?

- The loyal: High-Value Loyalists
- The cart abandoners: Cart Abandoners 24h
- The lapsed: Lapsed 90
- The brand-new: New This Month
- The window shoppers: Window Shoppers

KEY IDEA

Anjali wants five groups for the relaunch. Old Bloom needed two days of spreadsheets for one list; new Bloom defines each group once.

A list rots; an audience is a living rule

Question	A list	An audience
What is it?	A snapshot of people	A rule about people
After export	Starts rotting	Keeps being re-checked
Someone buys tonight	Still listed as lapsed	Leaves on her own
Reads	Whatever was exported	The merged profile

KEY IDEA

A list is a snapshot that starts rotting on export. An audience is a rule the platform keeps re-checking on the merged profile.

Create audience: Build rule or Compose audience

Method	What it does	Use it when
Build rule	Opens the Segment Builder	Describing people by data
Compose audience	A workflow over audiences	Combining finished audiences

KEY IDEA

Create audience offers two methods. Build rule opens the Segment Builder; Compose audience combines audiences you already have.

The Segment Builder's three panels

Panel	What it holds
Left: Fields	Attributes, Events and Audiences tabs
Centre: the canvas	The rule you are building
Right: properties	Estimates, Code view, Evaluation method

KEY IDEA

Left: Fields, with Attributes, Events and Audiences tabs. Centre: the rule canvas. Right: Audience properties, down to Evaluation method.

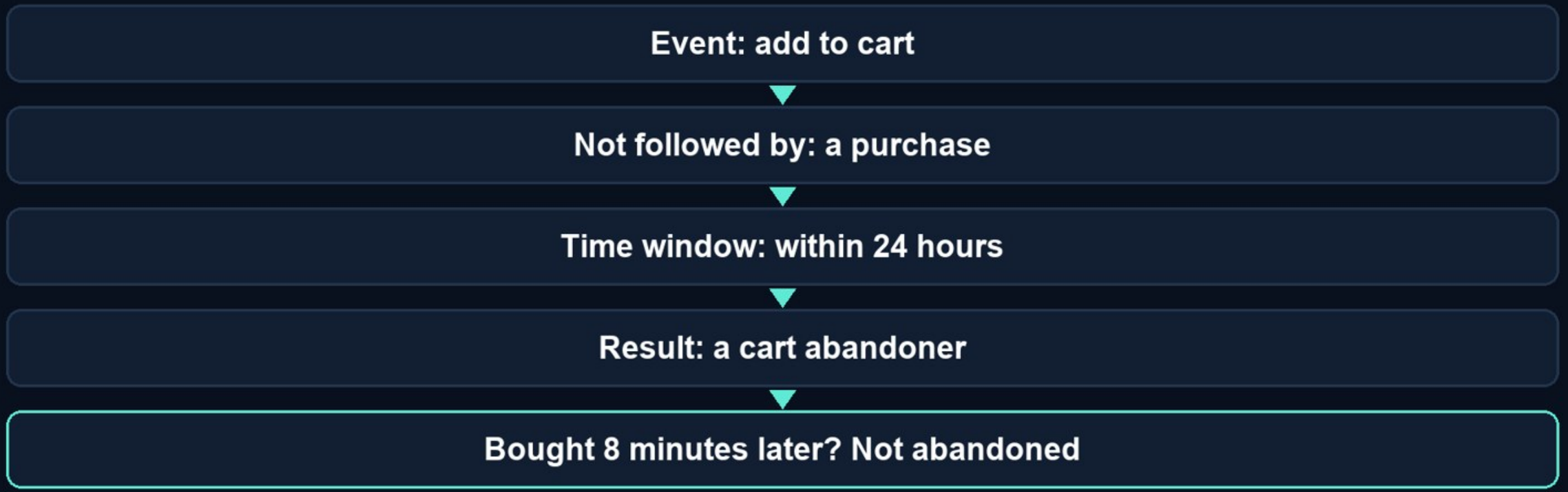
Four kinds of logic

Logic	Bloom example
Attribute	Loyalty band is Gold
Event with a time window	An order in the last 90 days
Sequential	Add to cart, no purchase in 24 hours
Exclusion	5+ views in 30 days, zero orders ever

KEY IDEA

Attributes, events with a time window, sequential rules and exclusion cover nearly every audience Bloom will ever need.

Sequential logic: not followed by



KEY IDEA

Sequential logic is a rule where the order of events matters: one event, then another, or the absence of one, inside a time window.

The relaunch five, from a written spec

Audience	Rule in one line
High-Value Loyalists	Gold band, 3+ orders in 12 months
Cart Abandoners 24h	Add to cart, no purchase in 24h
Lapsed 90	Last order 90+ days ago, email consent
New This Month	First-ever order in the last 30 days
Window Shoppers	5+ views in 30 days, zero orders ever

KEY IDEA

Kavya builds from a written spec, one sentence per audience, and refuses every condition the spec does not ask for.

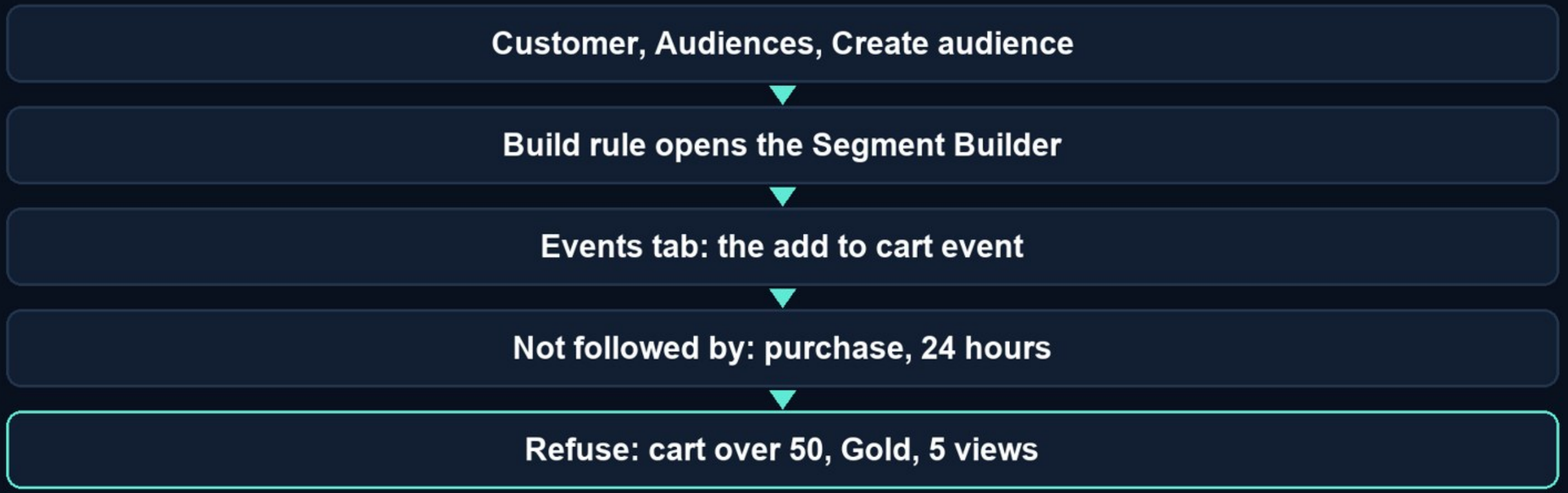
High-Value Loyalists and three traps

Condition	Verdict	Why
Loyalty band is Gold	Keep	The derived band from points
3+ orders in 12 months	Keep	Value shows in repeat orders
Email opens 3 or more	Refuse	No email data in AEP yet
Home city is Dallas	Refuse	A city is not value
Has an ECID	Refuse	Any visitor gets one

KEY IDEA

Keep loyalty band Gold and three or more orders in twelve months. Refuse email opens, a Dallas filter and has an ECID.

Cart Abandoners: an event, a gap and a clock



KEY IDEA

There is no cart object. A cart is add-to-cart events not followed by a purchase, so the audience is a sequential rule with a 24-hour window.

Lapsed 90 and consent inside the rule

Condition	Verdict	Why
Last order over 90 days ago	Keep	Recency defines lapsed
Email consent is true	Keep	The win-back is an email
No orders ever	Refuse	Never-buyers never started
Points below 500	Refuse	Points are not recency
SMS consent is true	Refuse	Wrong channel

KEY IDEA

Lapsed 90 needs a past order, none in 90 days, and email consent true. Ananya never consented, so she can never reach the win-back file.

New This Month and Window Shoppers

Trap condition	Audience	Why it is wrong
Any order, ever	New This Month	Nearly everyone has ordered
Profile created in 30 days	New This Month	A CRM row is not a purchase
Loyalty band is Bronze	New This Month	Tier does not mean new
Added to cart once	Window Shoppers	That is the abandoner
Last order over 90 days	Window Shoppers	Contradicts zero orders

KEY IDEA

New means a first-ever order in the last 30 days, not any order ever. Window Shoppers use exclusion: five views and zero orders.

Our good customers in Texas

Vague word	The decision hiding inside it
good	Tier, lifetime spend or order count?
customers	Any profile, or only buyers?
in Texas	Home, billing or last shipping address?
(unsaid) consent	Do we hold marketing consent?

KEY IDEA

A vague request hides four decisions: what good means, who counts as a customer, which address says Texas, and consent.

Code view: the PQL behind the canvas

- Rule: lives in Texas
- homeAddress.stateProvince = "TX"
- Add: has at least one order
- xEvent[commerce.order.purchaseID != null].count() >= 1
- Read Code view after every change

KEY IDEA

Code view shows the Profile Query Language the builder writes for you. Reading it lets you check what the canvas really built.

Common mistakes and the interview line

- Exporting lists instead of building rules
- Building straight from a vague brief
- Adding conditions just because they exist
- Leaving consent to a send-time checklist
- Forgetting the time window
- Interview: an audience is a living rule

KEY IDEA

Avoid the classic audience mistakes, and say it in one sentence: an audience is a living rule, not a list.

Recap, your question, and next time

- A list rots; an audience is a living rule
- Attribute, event and window, sequence, exclusion
- Every condition must earn its place
- Consent lives inside the rule
- Next: batch, streaming or edge

KEY IDEA

Lists rot, audiences live; four kinds of logic; refuse trap conditions; consent in the rule. Next: batch, streaming or edge.